ZCAS University

CIT5251 – STRATEGIC IT PLANNING AND MANAGEMENT

MID TERM TEST

MONDAY 20th APRIL 2026

17.30 - 19.00 HOURS

TIME ALLOWED: ONE AND HALF HOURS (plus 5 minutes to read through the paper)

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. Read the scenario attached as Appendix A, and
2. Answer any **TWO** questions from three questions provided on the question paper. All questions carry 25 marks.
3. Candidates must **not turn this** page until the invigilator tells them to do so.

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Question 1.

a) Evaluate how digital systems reshaped job roles at ZX. (5 Marks)

b) Apply socio-technical theory to ZX's transformation. (10 Marks)

c) Assess the impact of digital systems on employee productivity. (10 Marks)

[Total: 25 Marks]

Question 2.

a) Analyse the strategic role of IT in ZX's transformation. (10 Marks)

b) Critically assess cloud adoption at ZX. (5 Marks)

c) Explain the importance of IT-business alignment, Apply it to ZX.(10 Marks)

[Total: 25 Marks]

Question 3.

a) Evaluate ZX's IT governance structure. (5 Marks)

b) Apply the strategic grid model to ZX. (10 Marks)

c) Recommend improvements to IT management at ZX. (10 Marks)

[Total: 25 Marks]

APPENDIX A

Case Study: Digital Transformation at ZANTEL-X (ZX Telecom Solutions)

Background

ZANTEL-X (ZX Telecom Solutions) is a mid-sized telecommunications and digital services provider operating across Southern Africa. Historically, ZX relied on legacy infrastructure, siloed departments, and manual processes for customer onboarding, billing, and service provisioning. While the company maintained a stable customer base, increasing competition from agile fintech and mobile network operators forced ZX to rethink its operational and strategic positioning.

The executive board initiated a **digital transformation programme** aimed at:

- Improving operational efficiency
- Enhancing customer experience
- Enabling data-driven decision-making
- Creating new digital revenue streams

The transformation was guided by three core strategic pillars aligned with **digital Systems and the Design of Work, information Systems and Digital Transformation and Business of Information Technology.**

ZX implemented enterprise-wide systems including, ERP for finance and HR, CRM for customer lifecycle management and Workflow automation tools. The redesign shifted employees from repetitive administrative tasks to **knowledge-based roles**. For example, customer service agents transitioned into **customer experience analysts and** Network engineers began using predictive analytics tools

However, challenges emerged, particularly resistance to change from employees, skills gaps in digital competencies and over-reliance on automation without redesigning workflows properly

ZX introduced several digital initiatives, including Mobile self-service app, AI-powered chatbot for customer support and Big data analytics for personalized offerings. The transformation required a shift from **IT as a support function** to **IT as a strategic enabler**. Leadership adopted Agile development practices, Cloud-based infrastructure and API integration with fintech partners

Despite these advancements, the following issues surfaced:

- Integration complexity across legacy and modern systems
- Data governance concerns
- Misalignment between business strategy and IT execution

ZX restructured its IT governance framework by establishing an IT steering committee, introducing IT investment portfolio management and Implementing service-level agreements (SLAs).

The CIO repositioned IT using the **strategic grid model**, identifying systems as:

- Strategic (customer analytics platform)
- Factory (billing systems)
- Support (HR systems)

Financial scrutiny increased, requiring ROI justification for digital investments, cost optimization through cloud migration and vendor management strategies.

Despite increased financial scrutiny, IT costs initially increased due to transformation investments, benefits realization was slower than expected and Governance structures were seen to be still maturing.

Conclusion

ZX's transformation highlights the complexity of aligning **digital systems, organizational design, and IT governance**. While progress is evident, long-term success depends on three things:

- Continuous capability development
- Strong IT-business alignment
- Effective change management